



TEXAS A&M UNIVERSITY
Education &
Human Development

Default Question Block

TAMU Gardens in Focus Post-Experience Survey

Title of Research Study: Evaluation of the TAMU Gardens in Focus time-series project

Investigator: Shaun D. Hutchins, Ph.D.

Study ID: STUDY##

Approval Date: #/#/2026

Why am I being asked to take part in this research study?

You are invited to participate in this study because we are trying to learn more about the TAMU Gardens in Focus time-series

project. You were selected as a possible participant because you participated in the Gardens in Focus project. You must be 18 years of age or older to participate.

Why is this research being done?

The survey is designed to help us understand your experiences with the education and fieldwork in the Gardens in Focus project.

How long will the research last?

This survey should take approximately 15–20 minutes to complete.

What happens if I say "Yes, I want to be in this research"?

If you decide to participate, please complete the survey items to the best of your knowledge.

What happens if I do not want to be in this research?

Your participation in this study is voluntary. You can decide not to participate in this research and it will not be held against you. You can leave the study at any time.

Is there any way being in this study could harm me?

There are no sensitive questions in this survey that should cause discomfort. However, you can skip any question you do not wish to answer, or exit the survey at any point.

What happens to the information collected for the research?

Efforts will be made to limit the use and disclosure of your personal information, including research study and other records, to people who have a need to review this information. We cannot promise complete privacy. Organizations that may inspect and copy your information include the TAMU HRPP/IRB and other representatives of this institution. Your information will be kept

confidential to the extent allowed by law. The results of the research study may be published but your identity will remain confidential. Your name and email address will be stored separately from your survey data, and is only being collected for disaggregation purposes. All identifiable information will be kept on a password protected computer and is only accessible by the research team. Compliance offices at Texas A&M may be given access to the study files upon request. If direct identifiers are removed from your identifiable private information that are collected during this research, that information could be used for future research studies or distributed to another investigator for future research studies without your additional informed consent. You may view the survey host's confidentiality policy at : <https://www.qualtrics.com/privacy-statement/>

Who can I talk to?

Please feel free to ask questions regarding this study. You may contact me later if you have additional questions or concerns at (979) 845-8384, shaun.hutchins@tamu.edu. You may also

contact the Human Research Protection Program at Texas A&M University (which is a group of people who review the research to protect your rights) by phone at 1-979-458-4067, toll free at 1-855-795-8636, or by email at irb@tamu.edu for:

- additional help with any questions about the research
- voicing concerns or complaints about the research
- obtaining answers to questions about your rights as a research participant
- concerns in the event the research staff could not be reached
- the desire to talk to someone other than the research staff

If you want a copy of this consent for your records, you can print it from the screen.

If you wish to participate, please click the “I Agree” button and you will be taken to the survey. If you do not wish to participate in this study, please select “I Disagree” or select X in the corner of your browser.

- ☐ I Agree
- ☐ I Disagree

Recruitment

This block of questions will help us evaluate project recruitment.

How did you learn of the TAMU Gardens in Focus opportunity?

What motivated you to apply for the TAMU Gardens in Focus program? (Select all that apply). I wanted to...

- ☐ Explore my interest in oceanography
- ☐ Gain hands-on experience in fieldwork
- ☐ Gain hands-on experience analyzing time-series data

- ☐ Clarify which field I wanted to study
- ☐ Clarify whether I wanted to pursue a science research career
- ☐ Have a good intellectual challenge
- ☐ Work more closely with a particular faculty member
- ☐ Participate in a program with a strong reputation
- ☐ Clarify whether graduate school would be a good choice for me
- ☐ Get good letters of recommendation
- ☐ Enhance my application to graduate school
- ☐ Enhance my resume
- ☐ Other

Research groups

This block of questions will help us evaluate your empowerment to perform discipline-specific work in your field.

How much did you GAIN in the following skills in classic oceanographic and aquatic methods as a result of your

participation in the TAMU Gardens in Focus project?

	No gain	Small gain	Moderate gain	Great gain	Not applicable - I did not work with this skill
Engaging in fieldwork in general	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Aquatic sampling techniques	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Data collection methods	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Troubleshooting	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Evaluating water quality	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Evaluating microbial biodiversity	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Evaluating nutrient cycling	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Evaluating physical parameters	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Data management	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Evaluating time-series data	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Working in a lab	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Working collaboratively with others	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Communicating with scientists	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

	No gain	Small gain	Moderate gain	Great gain	Not applicable - I did not work with this skill
The scientific method	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Logistical planning	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

During your participation in the TAMU Gardens in Focus program, how much did you...

	Not at all	A little	A moderate amount	A great deal
Engage in real-science research	☐	☐	☐	☐
Feel like a scientist	☐	☐	☐	☐
Interact with scientists	☐	☐	☐	☐
Feel part of a scientific community	☐	☐	☐	☐
Try out new ideas or procedures on your own	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Not at all	A little	A moderate amount	A great deal
Feel responsible for your research project	☐	☐	☐	☐
Feel recognized for skill in aquatic methods	☐	☐	☐	☐

Motivation

This block of questions will help us evaluate motivation to explore research opportunities and careers that involve fieldwork.

Based on your TAMU Gardens in Focus fieldwork experience, how likely are you now to...

	Much less likely	Somewhat less likely	Somewhat more likely	Much more likely
Explore additional field-based research experiences on-campus	☐	☐	☐	☐

	Much less likely	Somewhat less likely	Somewhat more likely	Much more likely
Explore additional lab-based research experiences on-campus	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enroll in related, elective coursework	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enroll in a graduate program in a related field	☐	☐	☐	☐
Pursue a career in a related field	☐	☐	☐	☐

Connections

This block of questions will help us evaluate the connections with coursework.

How much did the following experiences support your learning in

general?

	Not at all	A little	A moderate amount	A great deal	Not applicable - I did not do this activity
Field experiences	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Lab experiences	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

How much did the following experiences prepare you for related coursework?

	Not at all	A little	A moderate amount	A great deal	Not applicable - I did not do this activity
Field experiences	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Lab experiences	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Feedback

What were the most valuable experiences provided by the TAMU Gardens in Focus program?

A large, empty rectangular text box with a thin gray border, intended for the respondent's answer to the first question.

If you were given the opportunity to discuss the TAMU Gardens in Focus program with the program developers, what changes would you recommend they make to the experience?

A large, empty rectangular text box with a thin gray border, intended for the respondent's answer to the second question.

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